

as just now he presses himself against the divide, becoming the dust particles that drift wantingly in the column of light that enters from the outside world, crossing the bathroom and hitting upon the threshold, the patina of his brogues beyond, atrophying his body and self into the lingering voice that crawls under the frame and rises slowly, listlessly, stained upon the mirror and the towels and the pale labels of the creams scattered upon the counters grain. He is the dust, baby, the dust and the voice that hangs above us as we lie, touching the rains above our heads as I hold yours to the crux of my shoulder, the dust and the voice in the shape of a man who stands outside the door of our tombs, the shape of a man who is at once everything and nothing. Because time has shed its corporeal body, has dissolved into *place* and become itself a state of *crossing* where the binary poles of existence woven into the fabric of reality have been distressed into an unrecognisable state. And the itinerants that we have now become, baby, within this transitory passage of the marshland, where the immediacy of the moment has been stretched taut over the belly of life, my hand upon your own, baby, as you feel yourself kick gently against the divide, where you turn further into that puddle with which you lie and that swells within my womb, the vegetal state of the past growing within the present and the present within the past. And now, as I breath in this humid air from here upon the showers floor, taking deep within myself the dust particles that are the shape of a man and his voice, where they line the walls of my lungs, so that as I sit here upon this broken crossbuck, threading strands of sedge between my fingers, as the light rain that has begun falling upon the face of the marshes waters wrests ripples from its stillness, passing spectrally across and through one another, distorting the image of the pondweeds and the milfoils of its shallows, do I cough, and his voice and his shape is visible within the warm condensation of my breath that hangs momentarily and forever on the body of the unseen world we have become lost within. And I am the doe, baby, clad in the bridal dresses of women laid in quicklime and oils, those wrapped in the same shallows from which we have come and where we may go, where the fruit weathered to purple grows in the tombs orchard, upon the overriding branches that had once shrouded the crossbuck and from where they had fallen into this side of the world, their mottled skins having come apart upon impact. Echos like rain and like footsteps, these clear blue ripples of place and time. And as the reddening

pink from between my thighs does now upon this showers floor, so do the dark juices bled from the purpled fruits flesh proliferate outwardly, diffused across and throughout the clear blue ripples, clouding the marshes waters as it does my eyes from up here upon the crossbuck, as I once again cough, and the man and his voice in the shape of dust is born anew. And that dust, baby, that dust that is the shape of a man and his voice, it is the silt that stirs upon the floor of the puddle with which you lie, it is the years thick upon violins and pianos and cellos, wrested from their once famed lives in concert halls and salons, now hidden away within storehouses and attics, in corners of a minds garret where the gut of their strings slacken, where the grain of their spruce and their maple is beginning now to buckle, he is the dust upon the rotting wood of the credenzas and bed frames, bookcases and tables, abandoned forever in apartment buildings, their one time owners having themselves dissolved into the dust that is the shape of a man and his voice, all sifted through the column of light that enters from the outside world before settling upon possessions of a previous life, and where they are now shaped into language by the slight of the children's fingers, becoming the negative half of those hieroglyphs that speak in the same tongues as the ones that had been cut from the mouth, from the mouths of those who had hidden away within their crawlspaces and below their floorboards, within the sanctuaries of their very own minds, the instruments that those men clad in uniform had come searching for, when in hours of twilight and dawn they would invade home after home, placing the cool blades of their knives to the throats of those now dumb women and men, against the pale breasts of their children washed in the light of the moon in which man and voice had sung in a funereal tone, those men in uniform asking again and again for the last time, always with a wry smile, where they had hidden the instruments, and that if they would only tell them, they would be on their way, and baby, as I laid there in the dark of that crawlspace listening to the muffled voices of the world beyond, cradling the wood of your hourglass like shape against my chest, my hand upon the back of your ebony neck, did a wind stir, the very same wind that now ruffles the blue of my dress upon this pregnant belly of mine from up here upon the crossbuck, a wind that wrested from your vocal cords made of catgut a dissonant cry, a one that proliferates outwardly as had done the juices bled from the flesh of the purpled fruits, and as it intertwines itself

within the weft and the warp of that distressed fabric of reality, whereupon *place* begins to spread outwardly through the echoing ripples of *time*, do I hear your cry, baby, from here upon the showers floor where it rises above the sound of the marshes waters hitting upon the white of my skin, flattening out the hair of arm and leg, pubis and brow, your cry rising upwardly with the steam that clouds the glass of our tombs, towards that column of light that enters in through the outside world and where the dust particles that are the shape of a man and his voice linger in that state of ephemerality, having been displaced from within the hold of the moment so as to at once be present in all those which precede and proceed it, until it eventually, the moment having come to encompass in its entirety that of *time* dissolved into *place*, collapses in upon itself and returns again to that of the singular, where it now breaks through onto the face of the beaten marsh, is driven into the breasts of those children who stand within the light of the moon. Your cry, baby, like the dust that is the shape of a man and his voice, is forever bound within this cycle. And now, as the blood from between my legs is let upon the floor of those homes from the necks of those women and men, where it too proliferates outwardly like *place* and *cry*, where it mixes with the ones of the children who now wear with a naked clarity this recurrent substrate of which the filial generations had germinated upon and will continue forever to do so, do we, baby, you and I from here within the narrow of this crawlspace, upon the floor of this shower and from where I sit here upon this crossbuck within the passage of the marshland, close these hooded lids of ours over ourselves and the world and return to within the primordial womb that sits at the utmost extremities of *place* and *time*, around and within the blood of the fruit and the *cry* dissolved upon it, returning to that place from where we have come and to where we still may go, awakening now beneath the glassy sheet of the marshes waters. These cloudy eyes of ours, *haec cogitatio fiet totum*¹. And the doe that I am, baby, as I submerge these hoofs of mine within the sluice of dreams, the synoneiros² that is forever still and always moving, its laminar flow gliding gently across the face of the marsh, do I step across and through its vegetation—just as I had when wading through the field of wraiths in search of this broken crossbuck upon which I now sit—these rushes and cattails at who's base swells the

¹ (Latin) — This reflection becomes the whole | This thought will become everything

² Syn + oneiros (Latin) = Synoneiros — Together + Dream = Togetherness of Dreams

oviposits, the already emergent nymphs having begun to unfold the rib of their wings as they toil within wash of the marshes water, abandoned by The Three Graces, Venus now naked and exposed, bereft of a substrate on which to emerge, cursed into the form of an insect caught eternally within its state of metamorphose, watching as those in the realised image of the nymph flit between the reeds, these dragonflies and damselflies alighting momentarily upon the doe that I am, just as they had done your exposed skin, my child, my boy, can you feel the touch of its claws upon this hide of mine? hear the hum effused by the translucent membrane of its wings? do you now turn further into that puddle which cradles the cheeks of my withered face in the soft of its sallow hands? this watery grave of ours, baby, this watery grave of which I now lower my doe's face toward, meeting those cloudy eyes of the pregnant women who sits upon the broken crossbuck, the one flattening out the blue of her dress over the taut skin of her belly, feeling of your deft kicks, baby, as they meet those hands which hold you own, their frailty pressed up against the bridge of the divide. And as I further elongate my neck, my tongue disturbing the still of dreams, the ennui of those women's eyes who are mine and that are brushed now into the rippled ones of the doe, do I drink deep of its waters, taking within me *time* and *place* and *cry*, the blood bled from the flesh of the purpled fruits which now mixes with the paint and lacquer of the violins and cellos, the pianos, all those instruments now entombed within a transient eternity. And as the threads of lace are freed from the dresses which clad my hide, drifting wantingly in the manner of the dust through a column of light, do they settle themselves upon the surface of the marshes shallows, blithe in their lilt above the broken shapes of the wooden bodies rotting quietly within,